Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

FOURTH REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 545

RESOLUTION STRONGLY CONDEMNING THE BRUTAL ATTACK THAT KILLED ATTY. JUNISA KIMAMAO AND WOUNDED ATTY. IBRAHIM PENDATU, CALLING FOR JUSTICE, A THOROUGH AND TRANSPARENT INVESTIGATION, AND IMMEDIATE ACTION TO ENSURE THE SAFETY OF LEGAL PROFESSIONALS IN THE BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION

WHEREAS, Section 4, Article II of the 1987 Constitution of the Philippines states in part that the prime duty of the Government is to serve and protect the people, and Section 11 of the same article declares that the State values the dignity of every human person and guarantees full respect for human rights;"

WHEREAS, Section 1, Article III of the Bill of Rights states that *"no person shall be deprived of life, liberty, or property without due process of law, nor shall any person be denied the equal protection of laws;*

WHEREAS, Article IX of Republic Act No. 11054, also known as the *"Organic Law for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao,"* underscores the importance of promoting and protecting human rights and commits to the establishment of mechanisms to ensure the dignity and safety of all individuals within the region;

WHEREAS, Section 6, Article IX of the abovementioned Act explicitly provides that the Bangsamoro Government shall fully respect human rights;

WHEREAS, on March 17, 2025, Atty. Junisa Kimamao, a young and dedicated lawyer, was senselessly ambushed and killed in Maguindanao del Norte, and her fiancé, Atty. Ibrahim Pendatu, was critically injured in the attack;

WHEREAS, the police report from Datu Odin Sinsuat (DOS), stated that Atty. Kimamao and Atty. Pendatu were aboard their vehicle traversing the highway of Barangay Awang, when they were shot by two gunmen aboard a motorcycle;

WHEREAS, Atty. Junisa Kimamao was a young and accomplished lawyer who dedicated her life to upholding justice and serving her community and the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region where she worked tirelessly to provide legal services and advocate for the rule of law;

WHEREAS, in the Holy Qur'an, verse 33 of *Surah Al-Isra* states: *"Do not take a human life, which is made sacred by Allah, except with legal right. If anyone is killed unjustly, we have given their heirs the authority, but do not let them exceed limits in retaliation, for they are already supported by law."*

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To strongly condemn the brutal attack that killed Atty. Junisa Kimamao and wounded Atty. Ibrahim Pendatu, calling for justice, a thorough and transparent investigation, and immediate action to ensure the safety of legal professionals in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To urge the Philippine National Police (PNP), the National Bureau of Investigation (NBI), the Local Government Unit of DOS, and other relevant authorities to conduct a thorough, transparent, and impartial investigation into the deadly attack on Atty. Kimamao and Atty. Pendatu, to ensure that all perpetrators are held accountable under the full force of the law; and to call on the same authorities to take immediate measures to enhance the security and protection of legal professionals and justice workers in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, To direct the BTA Committee on Public Order and Safety and the Committee on Local Government to jointly conduct an investigation, in aid of legislation, into this brutal attack and other similar incidents of killings in the same municipality.

RESOLVED, FINALLY, To furnish a copy of this resolution to appropriate authorities, including the PNP, the NBI, the Ministry of Public Order and Safety, the Local Chief Executive of DOS and other relevant government agencies for their information and necessary action.

ADOPTED, *Shawwal* 24, 1446/April 22, 2025.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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